

CSS Pakistan Affairs: Detailed Revision Notes

1905 – 1924 Era

1 Partition of Bengal (Oct 16, 1905)

Key Takeaway

Administrative division by **Lord Curzon** on **October 16, 1905** aiming for efficiency, but strategically employed to weaken Hindu nationalism (Bhadralok) and cultivate Muslims. This was a classic execution of the colonial “**divide and rule**” strategy.

split, and the “Extremist” faction led by the **Lal-Bal-Pal** trio (Lajpat Rai, Tilak, B.C. Pal) alongside Aurobindo Ghosh took center stage, demanding absolute **Swaraj** (self-rule).

2 Muslim Awakening (1906)

Shift in Strategy

Witnessing the immense, well-funded, and religiously charged Hindu mobilization, Muslims realized Sir Syed Ahmad Khan’s defensive strategy of “political aloofness” was obsolete. Survival required constitutional safeguards and a sovereign political platform.

1.1 Administrative Context

- **Size:** Undivided Bengal was practically unmanageable (nearly 78 million population).
- **Inequality:** East Bengal (where the Muslim peasantry was concentrated) remained severely underdeveloped. Wealth, educational institutions, and development were centralized in Calcutta (the capital), heavily dominated by the Hindu elite.

1.2 The Partition Mechanics

- **Western Bengal:** Included Bihar and Orissa, with a clear Hindu majority. Calcutta remained its capital.
- **Eastern Bengal & Assam:** Newly created province with a clear Muslim majority (roughly 18 million Muslims out of 31 million). Its new capital was established at **Dhaka**.

1.3 Hindu Backlash & Swadeshi Movement

- **Perception:** The educated Hindu elite and landed gentry of West Bengal viewed it as a calculated, insidious attack on their nascent nationalism and a deliberate attempt to sever their cultural and linguistic unity.
- **Economic Boycott:** On **August 7, 1905**, at Calcutta’s Town Hall, the **Swadeshi** (self-reliance/use native goods) movement was formally proclaimed, alongside a massive **Boycott** (public bonfires of foreign cloth, boycott of British goods, schools, and courts).
- **Communal Alienation:** The movement was propelled by exclusive Hindu religious symbolism (veneration of the goddess Kali and the rallying cry *Bande Mataram* – Hail to the Mother). Because Muslims supported the partition, Hindu merchants economically boycotted Muslim traders to coerce them into withdrawing support, turning an anti-British protest into a communal economic war.
- **Extremism:** Frustration birthed revolutionary terrorism (secret societies like *Anushilan Samiti* and *Jugantar*) introducing the cult of the bomb. The Congress

2.1 Simla Deputation (October 1, 1906)

- **The Delegation:** A delegation of 35 prominent Muslim nobles, intellectuals, and landowners, led by **Sir Aga Khan**, met Viceroy **Lord Minto** at Simla.
- **Core Argument:** Due to their distinct religion and culture, Muslims should not be treated as a mere numerical minority, but as a distinct political entity.
- **Core Demand: Separate Electorates** – the right for Muslims to be elected exclusively by Muslim voters to ensure true representation rather than “puppet” Muslims dependent on the Hindu majority vote. Minto gave a sympathetic response.

2.2 Birth of All-India Muslim League (Dec 30, 1906)

- **Foundation:** Formed during the annual meeting of the Muhammadan Educational Conference in Dhaka. Proposed by **Nawab Salimullah** of Dhaka.
- **Core Objectives:**
 1. To protect and advance the political rights and interests of the Muslims of India.
 2. To foster a sense of loyalty to the British government (a defensive necessity to secure British support against the aggressive Indian National Congress).
 3. To prevent the rise of hostility toward other communities (an attempt to keep the political struggle constitutional and non-violent).

3 Minto-Morley Reforms (1909)

Constitutional Milestone

The Indian Councils Act of 1909 officially accepted the demand for Communal Representation, effectively legalizing the foundation of the Two-Nation Theory.

3.1 The Provisions and Ideological Impact

- **British Calculus:** A strategic move to “rally the moderates” within the Congress away from rising terrorism, while satisfying Muslims to keep them as a loyal counterweight.
- **Separate Electorates:** Fixed seats exclusively reserved for Muslims, elected solely by Muslim voters. They were also granted “weightage” (seats in excess of population percentage). Lord Minto became known as the “father of communal electorate”.
- **Congress Reaction:** Fiercely criticized it as a sinister imperial application of “divide and rule” that broke Hindu-Muslim unity.

3.2 Legislative Limitations

- **Limited Legislative Power:** The expanded councils were glorified debating clubs. The British Viceroy retained absolute veto power. Lord Morley explicitly stated this was *not* meant to establish a parliamentary system.
- **The Official Majority Mechanism:** In the center, the British maintained a strict “official majority”. In the provinces, they allowed a “non-official majority”, but this included *nominated* loyalists who voted with the government, rendering elected Indians a powerless minority.

4 Annulment of Partition (1911)

The Annulment Reversal

Unable to permanently crush the intense Swadeshi agitation and terrorism, the British secretly bowed to Hindu pressure, shattering Muslim trust in the colonial administration.

- **The Reversal (December 1911):** At the coronation durbar in Delhi, King George V announced the annulment, reuniting Bengal. To punish the Bengali Hindu elite, the capital was simultaneously shifted from Calcutta to Delhi.
- **Impact on Muslim Perception:** The Muslim leadership learned a harsh lesson: the British rewarded violent Hindu agitation but betrayed peaceful Muslim loyalty.
- **Shift in AIML Objectives (1913):** The profound disillusionment triggered an internal revolution within the Muslim League. In 1913, with younger leaders like Jauhar and **M.A. Jinnah** joining, the AIML dropped

“loyalty to the British Crown” and adopted the radical goal of “**Self-Government**”, aligning its objective with the Congress.

5 Kanpur Mosque Incident (1913)

- **The Demolition Plan:** A civic road widening plan required demolishing a Hindu temple. When Hindus protested, the government altered the road, deciding to demolish the eastern washing place of the Machli Bazar Mosque instead.
- **Administrative Disregard:** Sir James Meston ignored Muslim petitions. The structure was demolished on July 1, 1913.
- **The Firing Incident (August 3, 1913):** A massive, unarmed Muslim procession symbolically placed bricks to rebuild it. The British magistrate (Tyler) ordered police to fire for 15 minutes, killing many. Resentment inflamed when Sir James Meston distributed merit certificates to the police who fired on the crowd, convincing Muslims of blatant British hatred.
- **National Mobilization:** The Muslim press, notably **Maulana Muhammad Ali Jauhar** (*The Comrade*), elevated this from a local grievance to a national anti-imperialist rallying cry, linking it to global pan-Islamic grief over the Balkan wars.
- **Result:** The unprecedented outrage forced Viceroy Lord Hardinge to intervene, calling the actions of Meston and Tyler a “**stupid blunder**.” The incident proved that Muslim masses could now be mobilized on a national scale, officially ending the era of political aloofness.

6 The Lucknow Pact (1916)

The Congress-League Alliance

Masterminded by **M.A. Jinnah**, this was a strategic alliance where the Congress and AIML forged a united constitutional front to demand self-rule from the British. For his monumental role, Jinnah was famously titled the “**Ambassador of Hindu-Muslim unity**” by Sarojini Naidu.

- **Catalysts for Unity:** Growing Muslim disillusionment with the British (driven by the annulment of the Partition of Bengal, the Kanpur Mosque tragedy, and British hostility toward the Ottoman Empire during WWI) pushed the Muslim League away from loyalty and aligned their anti-imperialist goals with the Congress.
- **Acceptance of Separate Electorates:** The Hindu-dominated Congress reversed its historical stance and officially accepted **Separate Electorates** for Muslims. This was a massive ideological victory for Muslims, as Congress validated the core premise of the Two-Nation Theory.
- **The Weightage Formula (Impact on Demographics):** To balance power, AIML was granted “weightage” (extra seats) in minority provinces (UP, Bombay). However, in exchange, AIML voluntarily surrendered its demographic majorities in the vital

provinces of **Bengal** (took 40% seats despite 52% population) and **Punjab** (50% seats despite 54% population). This severely handicapped Muslim provincial power.

- **Joint Demands for Self-Rule:** The Congress and Muslim League jointly presented a comprehensive constitutional framework to the British, demanding they immediately:
 - Grant India provincial autonomy and expand elected majorities in legislative councils.
 - Bind the executive branch to the decisions of the legislature.
 - Ensure **one-third (1/3) Muslim representation** in the Central/Imperial Legislature.
 - Implement a **Communal Veto:** No bill affecting a community could be passed if three-fourths (3/4) of that community's representatives opposed it.
 - Mandate that half (50%) of the members in the Imperial and Provincial Executive Councils be Indians.
 - Separate the executive from the judiciary.

This united, highly detailed constitutional front terrified the British, forcing them to issue the 1919 reforms.

- **The Backlash:** M.A. Jinnah resigned from the Imperial Legislative Council in protest, famously declaring that a government passing such laws in peacetime “**forfeits its claim to be called a civilized government.**” Gandhi launched a nationwide *hartal* (strike) on April 6, 1919 (Rowlatt Satyagraha).
- **Jallianwala Bagh Massacre (April 13, 1919):** Brigadier-General Reginald Dyer ordered troops to fire continuously on a massive unarmed crowd gathered for the Baisakhi festival in an enclosed ground in Amritsar. At least 379 were killed. The massacre permanently destroyed Indian faith in British justice.

8 Khilafat & Non-Cooperation (1919–1924)

Mass Political Awakening

An unprecedented Hindu-Muslim mass agitation. While it failed in its stated objectives, it permanently destroyed the myth of British invincibility and politicized the Muslim masses.

7 Reforms & Repression (1919)

Concession and Repression

The British deployed a dual strategy to manage post-WWI political awakening: the constitutional concession of the Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms (the Carrot) and the draconian Rowlatt Act (the Stick).

7.1 Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms (1919)

- **Dyarchy in Provinces:** A dual system of governance. Subjects were divided into **Reserved** (police, justice, finance, and land revenue – completely controlled by the British Governor) and **Transferred** (education, public health, local self-government, agriculture, and public works – handed to elected Indian ministers).
- **Structural Flaw of Dyarchy:** Indian ministers had responsibility for nation-building but possessed no financial power, making the system unworkable.
- **Restricted Franchise and Veto Power:** At the center, the Viceroy retained absolute veto power. The voting franchise was severely restricted by property/tax criteria to just 2-10% of the elite. Communal representation was aggressively expanded to Sikhs, Europeans, and Anglo-Indians.

7.2 The Rowlatt Act & Jallianwala Bagh (1919)

- **The “Black Act”:** To prevent revolutionary conspiracies, the British passed the Rowlatt Act (officially the **Anarchical and Revolutionary Crimes Act of 1919**), making wartime martial law permanent. It allowed arrest without trial for up to two years, suspended habeas corpus, and held secret trials (*Na Dalil, Na Vakil, Na Appeal*).

8.1 Genesis of the Khilafat Movement

- **Theological Context:** The Ottoman Sultan was recognized globally as the *Khalifa* (Caliph) and the supreme guardian of Islamic holy sites.
- **Violation of Wartime Pledges:** During WWI, British PM David Lloyd George promised Indian Muslims that the Ottoman Empire would not be dismembered. After winning, the British reneged (Treaty of Sèvres), carving up the empire.
- **The Khilafat Committee (1919):** Formed by the dynamic **Ali Brothers** (Jauhar and Shaukat Ali) along with **Maulana Abul Kalam Azad** and **Hasrat Mohani**. They presented three non-negotiable core demands:
 - The Ottoman Caliph must retain control over sufficient territory to defend the Islamic faith.
 - The pre-war territorial integrity of the Ottoman Empire must be restored and maintained.
 - *Jazirat-ul-Arab* (the Arabian Peninsula, including Mecca, Medina, Syria, Iraq, and Palestine) must remain under direct Muslim sovereignty, completely free from non-Muslim mandates.

8.2 The Strategic Alliance & Non-Cooperation

- **Gandhi's Strategic Alliance:** Gandhi allied with Muslim leaders, merging the demand to save the *Khilafat* with the Hindu demand for *Swaraj*, famously stating that “**such an opportunity to unite Hindus and Muslims might not arise again in a hundred years.**”
- **Mechanics of Non-Cooperation (1920):** A strictly non-violent campaign to paralyze administration: Indians renounced British titles, gave up government services, and comprehensively boycotted British law courts, foreign goods, and schools.

- **Hijrat Movement (1920):** Immense religious fervor led prominent scholars like **Maulana Abul Kalam Azad** and **Maulana Abdul Bari** to issue a decree declaring India *Dar-ul-Harb* (Enemy Territory). Driven by raw emotion, nearly 18,000 Muslims sold everything and migrated to Afghanistan, which eventually closed its borders, resulting in a catastrophic socio-economic disaster for Muslims.

8.3 Collapse and Legacy

- **Chauri Chaura Incident (Feb 1922):** After local police beat a volunteer leader and opened fire on a protesting crowd, an infuriated mob retaliated by attacking the police station and burning 22 policemen alive. Horrified by the violence and bound by his strict discipline of *Ahimsa* (non-violence), Gandhi unilaterally withdrew the entire Non-Cooperation Movement without consulting his Khilafat allies. This deeply betrayed the Muslims and permanently shattered Hindu-Muslim unity.
- **Abolition of the Caliphate (1924):** The final blow came from Turkey itself. The progressive secular nationalist, **Mustafa Kemal Atatürk**, formally abolished the institution of the Caliphate, removing the very foundation of the Indian agitation.
- **The Aftermath:** The alliance was exposed as a “marriage of convenience” built on overlapping anti-British anger, not identical political objectives. Once the unity collapsed, the anti-imperialist struggle devolved into aggressive religious communalism (Hindu *Shuddhi/Sangathan* vs Muslim *Tabligh/Tanzeem*). However, by merging Islamic symbols with mass politics, the movement laid the profound ideological foundation for Muslim separatism and the Two-Nation Theory.

tablishing Congress-League unity.

- **April 6, 1919:** Gandhi launches the Rowlatt Satyagraha nationwide.
- **April 13, 1919:** Jallianwala Bagh Massacre occurs in Amritsar.
- **1919:** All India Khilafat Committee is formed.
- **August 1920:** Non-Cooperation Movement is launched.
- **1920:** Hijrat Movement begins (migration to Afghanistan).
- **February 1922:** Chauri Chaura incident; Gandhi withdraws the movement.
- **1924:** Mustafa Kemal Atatürk formally abolishes the Caliphate.

9 Timeline of Key Events

Chronological Summary

- **July 19, 1905:** Lord Curzon officially announces the partition plan.
- **August 7, 1905:** The Swadeshi Movement is formally proclaimed at the Calcutta Town Hall.
- **October 16, 1905:** The actual physical and administrative division of Bengal takes effect.
- **October 1, 1906:** Simla Deputation meets Viceroy Lord Minto.
- **December 30, 1906:** All-India Muslim League is founded in Dhaka.
- **1909:** Minto-Morley Reforms grant Separate Electorates.
- **December 1911:** Annulment of the Partition of Bengal at the Delhi Durbar.
- **May 6, 1913:** Sir James Meston rules to demolish the Kanpur Mosque extension.
- **July 1, 1913:** The eastern structure of the Machli Bazar Mosque is demolished.
- **August 3, 1913:** Firing at Kanpur Mosque kills unarmed protesters.
- **1913:** AIML changes its core objective from “loyalty” to “Self-Government”.
- **December 1916:** Lucknow Pact is signed, es-